COMPETITOR BENCHMARK · FY2025

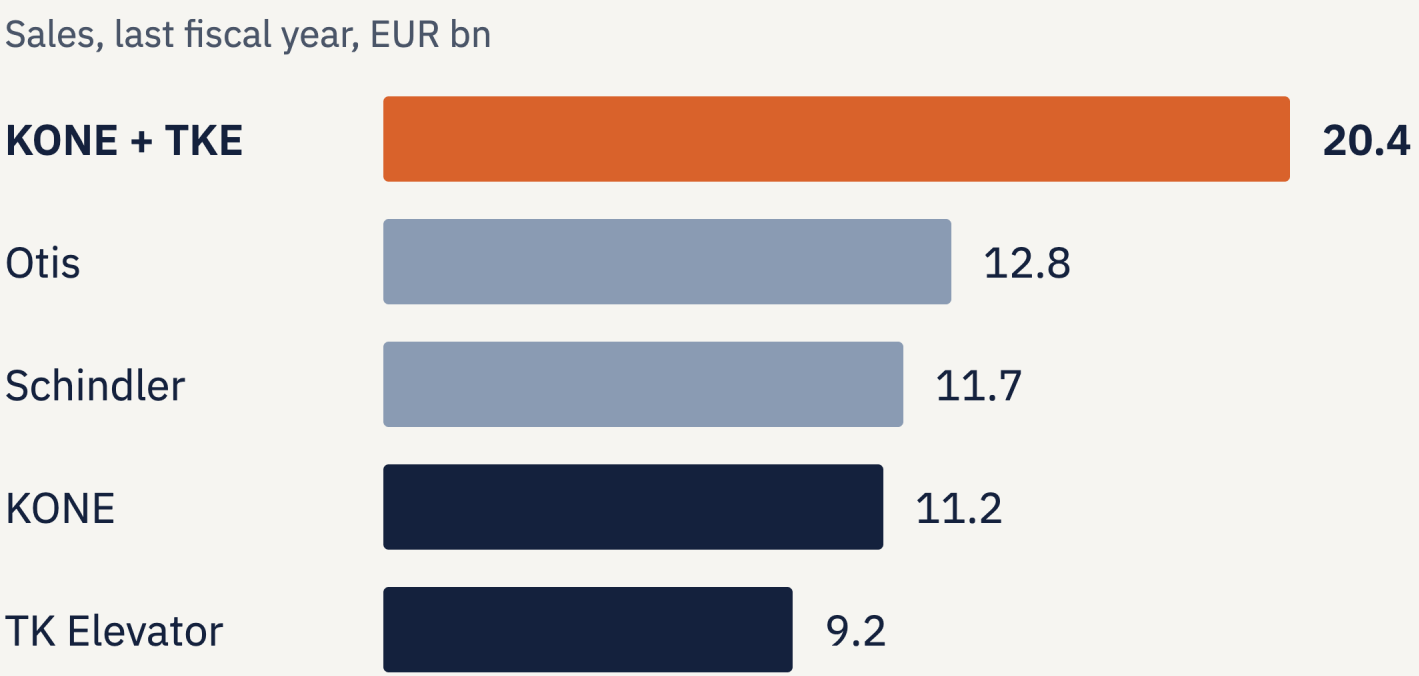
The elevator Big 4, benchmarked

KONE vs Otis, Schindler and TK Elevator, and what a combined KONE + TKE could look like

Tanvir Ahmed · October 2026

Illustrative analysis of public company reports

A combined KONE + TKE would be 1.6 times the size of Otis



3.2m
units under maintenance, vs 2.5m at Otis

~115k
employees, vs 72k at Otis

21% → 32%
US share of sales, KONE alone vs combined

Sources: company FY2025 reports (TKE: FY to Sep 2025); USD and CHF at ECB 2025 average rates. TKE US share from AFP deal coverage, Apr 2026.

Service and modernization already make up two-thirds of sales

Company	Service + mod. share	Units maintained
KONE	64%	1.8m
Otis	65%	2.5m
TK Elevator	65%	1.4m
Schindler	not disclosed	not collected
KONE + TKE	64%	3.2m

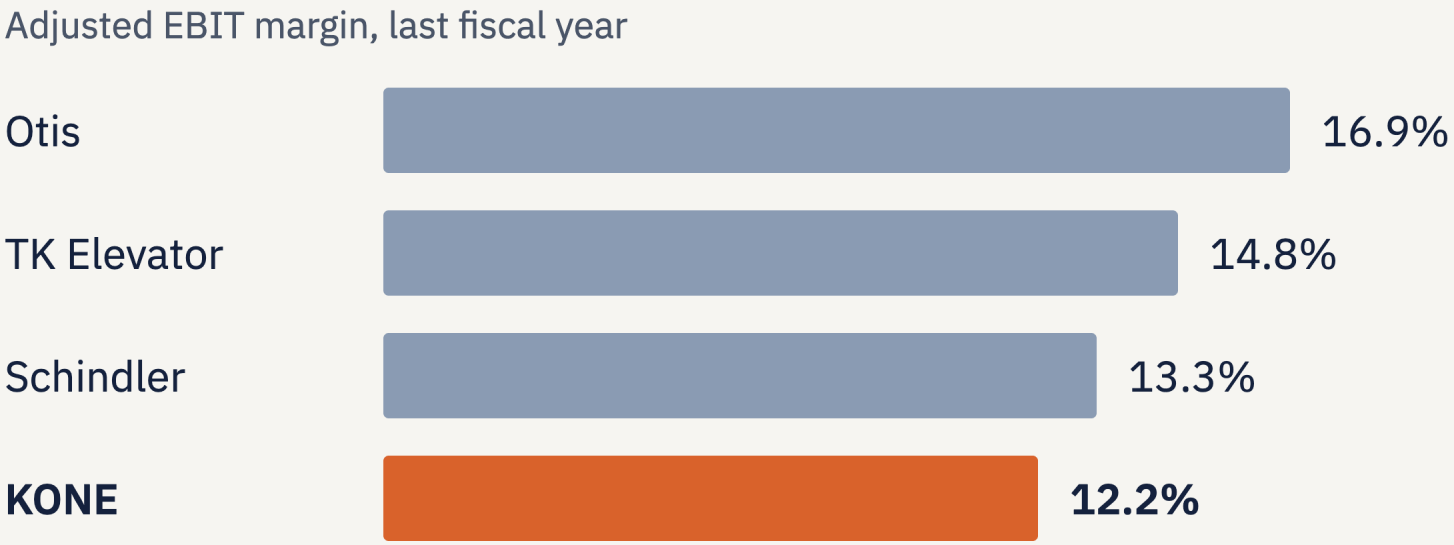
What this means

New-building sales are falling with China's property slump: KONE's Greater China sales fell 14% in 2025 and are now 19% of the group.

KONE's growth came from modernization (+17% at comparable rates) and service (+8%).

Sources: KONE Annual Review 2025; Otis FY2025 release (Service segment includes modernization); TKE FY2024/25 and H1 2025/26 releases.

KONE has the lowest adjusted EBIT margin of the Big 4



4.7 pp

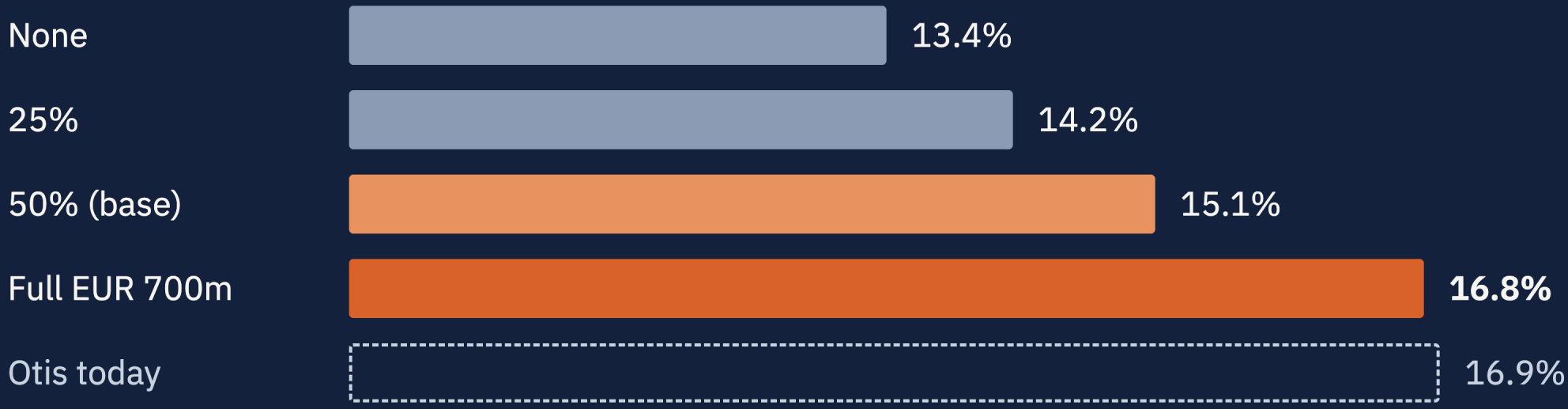
gap to Otis, worth about **EUR 530m** of EBIT a year at KONE's sales

KONE's own target: 13–14% by end of 2027

Company-defined adjusted margins (Otis: adjusted operating profit). TKE likely excludes acquisition amortisation, so its margin flatters the comparison.

With full synergies, a combined KONE + TKE would match Otis on margin

Pro forma adjusted EBIT margin by share of the EUR 700m synergies realised (axis starts at 10%)



Simple sum of KONE and TKE adjusted EBIT plus synergies; excludes integration costs, antitrust divestments and financing. Synergy target: KONE, 29 Apr 2026.

Takeaways and the questions I would test next

What the numbers say

1. KONE + TKE would be the clear #1 by sales (EUR 20.4bn) and installed base (3.2m units).

2. KONE trails all peers on margin by 1–5 pp; mix toward service is the lever.

3. Delivering the full EUR 700m would lift the combined margin to Otis's level.

What I would analyse next

Which countries overlap most, and where are divestments likely?

How fast can TKE's service base reach KONE's 40% connectivity?

What does a like-for-like margin look like after acquisition amortisation?

Full model with every source and 10 automated checks: elevator_benchmark_2025.xlsx. Illustrative analysis of public data, not investment advice.